Policy Name | Custodianship of Library Materials Policy

Policy Number I. Organization # 12

Date Issued February 29, 2008

I. Policy Statement

Brooklyn Public Library provides the borough's 2.5 million residents with timely access to library materials for informational, educational and recreational use. Books and other library materials are purchased with public funds, with some support coming from private donations. These books and other library materials are public property and are entrusted to the care of BPL on behalf of the public. To fulfill the Library's mission, and to properly meet the responsibility of BPL as a custodian of public property, it is the responsibility of all staff to safeguard library materials, ensure that all library materials are accessible to the public, and use the integrated library system (Millennium) ethically and in compliance with established Library procedures.

II. Procedures and Guidelines

Borrowing and returning:

- Staff must observe the same circulation rules as the public
- Library cards are limited to one per staff member
- Branch staff card circulation rules must be observed
- Staff must check out all library materials in their possession
- Staff may not check out or check in their own library materials
- Staff must renew library materials in a timely way
- Staff must return all checked out library materials in a timely way

Holds:

- Staff have the same holds privileges and borrowing limits as patrons
- Staff are to honor holds and are not to make any changes to the holds queue

Handling Library Materials:

- Vendor shipments must be unpacked within 2 business days of receipt and contents verified against packing slips. Staff must print their name, sign and date each packing slip before forwarding packing slip to Technical Processing Services.

- Shipments of new library materials must be checked in, holds captured, and all materials placed on public shelves within 2 business days of receipt
- Library materials must be handled with care and respect. Staff may not remove any library materials (including reference materials) from library premises without first checking them out via Millennium
- Returned library materials, Interchange shipments, and holds must be checked in and shelved as soon as possible.
- Library materials sent through Interchange must not be diverted from their intended locations
- Library procedures for making items lost or missing, discarding materials and preparing Better World Books shipments must be carefully observed

Failure to adhere to the above procedures will result in progressive discipline, up to and including termination of employment.

Responsibilities:

Executive Director's Office
Releases policy

Deputy Directors for Public Service and Business Administration
Provide ongoing policy review

Office of Library Technology
Includes policy on BPL Intranet

Supervisors
Monitor staff compliance

Staff
Acknowledge expectations of policy by signing *Custodianship of Library Materials Policy Acknowledgement Form*
http://bline.brooklynpubliclibrary.org/policies/organization/CustodianshipAcknowledgmentForm.pdf

Issuing Agency: Public Service Policy Committee
Policy Approved by the Board of Trustees: February 26, 2008

Related Documents: Brooklyn Public Library Mission Statement
http://bline.brooklynpubliclibrary.org/policies/organization/bpl_mission_statement.htm